

Vital Signs

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Chapter 12: four ideas to connect

Core vital signs

Measure temperature, pulse, respirations, and blood pressure accurately and compare with baseline.

Pulse oximetry

Obtain a reliable reading, consider accuracy limits, and respond to low or worsening results.

Height and weight

Use safe, consistent methods because measurements affect dosing and care planning.

Recording and reporting

Document promptly and communicate abnormal findings, symptoms, trends, and actions.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

A number becomes meaningful when you connect it with the patient and the trend.

Use the correct equipment and technique, repeat unexpected results when appropriate, and assess symptoms. Report urgent or worsening changes with the actual value, baseline, related findings, and actions taken.

- ✓ Use correct equipment and position
- ✓ Compare with baseline
- ✓ Repeat unexpected readings
- ✓ Assess related symptoms
- ✓ Document and report the trend

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

**Measure accurately.
Compare the trend.
Report the change.**

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.